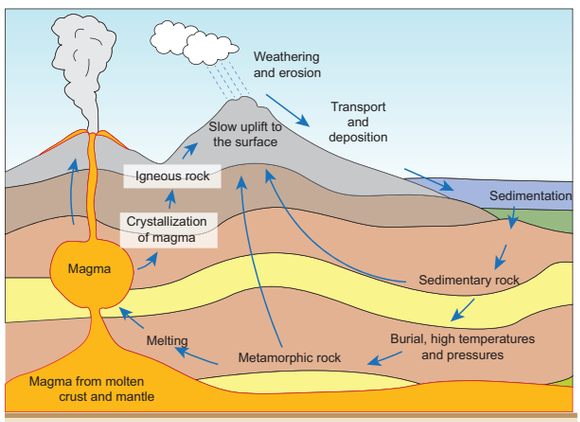
Metamorphic Rocks

The term 'metamorphic' is derived from the word 'metamorphosis', which means, 'change of form'. When igneous or sedimentary rocks are subjected to extreme heat and pressure, they undergo a complete change in their form and character .i.e., in course of time, granite may get transformed to gneiss, basalt to schist, limestone to marble and sandstone to quartzite.

Rock Cycle

The Rock cycle is a continuous process through which igneous, sedimentary and metamorphic rocks are transformed from one form to another.



Activity

Narrate the processes involved in the given rock cycle diagram in your own words.

1.4 Geomorphic Processes

The forces that act from the Earth's interior towards the Earth's surface are called **Internal processess** or **Endogenetic processes**. These forces build the landscape and create topographic relief.

The forces that act on the surface of the Earth due to natural agents like running water, glacier, wind, waves etc. are called **External processes** or **Exogenetic processes**. These external processes tear the landscape down into relatively low elevated plains and shapes the landform created by Endogenetic process.

Internal Processes

The internal processes generate heat and eject materials from deep below the Earth's crust. **Internal radioactivity** is the principal source of power for this process.

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Plate Tectonics

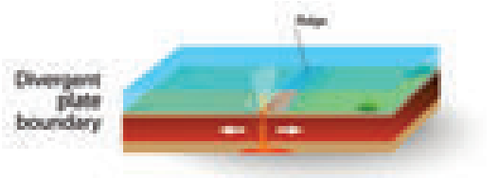
The lithosphere is divided into a number of huge slabs of rocks called '**Tectonic plates**.' These tectonic plates are divided into major and minor plates. These plates float independently over the mantle. Collisions of these plates produce mountain ranges and other irregular surface features, both on land and the ocean floor. This phenomenon is called '**plate tectonics**'. The movement of tectonic plates is due to thermal energy from the mantle. Now we have a better understanding about the plate movements and its relation to Earthquake and volcanic activities.

Types of Plate Boundaries

Convergent Boundary - Here the plate moves toward each other and sometimes, a plate sinks under another. The location where the sinking of a plate occurs is called a subduction zone (eg) Fold Mountain-Himalayas.



Divergent Boundary – Here the plates pull away from each other as magma pushes up from the mantle (eg) Mid Atlantic Ridge



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